Society for Computer Technology and Research's

PUNE INSTITUTE OF COMPUTER TECHNOLOGY

DHANKAWADI, PUNE – 43

(An Autonomous Institute affiliated to Savitribai Phule Pune University)

ConnectE: Trust - Enabled Hyperlocal Service Marketplace

Submitted by

Prathamesh Harpale - 21168

Srishti Pandey - 21181

Pradyum Umale - 21185

Abhay Wangwad - 21187

Attendance & Assessment Record

AY:	2025-26	Semester-IV
Class:	S Y - I	Batch- H1
Course:	[14090202]: Entrepreneurship Lab (EPL)	

Prof. P. A. Chavan

Name and sign of the faculty:
Department of Computer Engineering
PICT, Pune

Course Objectives: The objective of this course is to provide students with

- Explore the intersection of innovative strategies, economic principles, and management practices to drive entrepreneurial success.
- Ability to analyze market dynamics and craft innovative strategies for sustainable business growth in a competitive landscape.
- Tools and techniques for effective decision-making, resource allocation, and team management in entrepreneurial ventures.
- Incorporating sustainability and inclusivity into their entrepreneurial and managerial strategies aligns with global economic trends.

Course Outcomes: After completing this course, students will be able to

1409202-1: Demonstrate the ability to design and implement innovative strategies that integrate economic and managerial principles to solve complex business challenges. (BTL: L3: Analyze, L4: Analyze).
1409202-2: Analyze market trends, economic policies, and business environments to identify opportunities and mitigate risks. (BTL: L4: Analyze).

Articulation matrix mapping of CO with revised PO:

Course Outcomes (COs)	PO1	PO2	PO3	PO4	PO5	PO6	PO7	PO8	PO9	PO10	PO11
CO1	1	2	2	1	1	2	2	3	3	3	2
CO2	1	2	2	1	1	2	2	3	3	3	2

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Pune Institute of Computer Technology

Dhankawadi, Pune-411043

Department of Computer Engineering

Task to perform and schedule

Sr. No.	Task	Performance Date *Scheduled*	Submission Date *Scheduled*
Week-01	Group formation and Idea Initiation	12/01/26	17/01/26
Week-02 & 03	Case Study and list of resources required	18/01/26	31/01/26
Week-04 & 05	Project Work Plan and Management	01/02/26	14/02/26
Week-06 & 07	Work Breakdown Structure	15/02/26	28/02/26
Week-08 & 09	Monitoring, Market Analysis and Impact	01/03/26	14/03/26
Week-10	Documentation	15/03/26	21/03/26
Week-11 & 12	Final presentation and review	22/03/26	04/04/26
Week-13 & 14	Submission, conclusion and assessment.	05/04/26	18/04/26

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Activity

1. **EPL Project Title**:
   ConnectE - Trust Enabled Hyperlocal Service Marketplace

2. **Project Domain:**
   E-commerce & Marketplace Technology

3. **Scope of the Project:**
   The scope of ConnectE involves developing a hyperlocal, trust-enabled service marketplace that connects users with verified service providers for essential home services such as plumbing, electrical work, cleaning, and basic maintenance.

   The platform will include core features like service discovery, real-time booking and provider matching, live tracking, secure payments, and a rating and review system. It will also support service providers through onboarding, verification, job notifications, and earnings tracking. The project is limited to a pilot launch in a single city with a focus on building a functional MVP and basic customer support and dispute resolution system.

   However, large-scale expansion, advanced AI-based features, complex logistics, and in-house service operations are beyond the current scope. The project operates under constraints such as a limited timeline, budget, and initial provider network, while assuming that users and service providers have access to smartphones, internet connectivity, and are comfortable with digital payments.

4. **Roles and Responsibilities:**

Roll Number	Student Name	Roles	Responsibilities
21168	Prathamesh Harpale	Technical Lead	App architecture, backend, matching engine, admin panel, tech management
21181	Srishti Pandey	Team Leader; Product Lead	Business strategy, GTM execution, investor relations, brand, EPL
21185	Pradyum Umale	Marketing & Finance Lead	Financial projections, social media, branding assets, cost tracking
21187	Abhay Wangwad	Operations & Research Lead	Provider onboarding, dispute resolution, market & risk research

5. **Target SDG's**

The **17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** adopted by the United Nations in 2015 as part of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development:
(☐ Tick appropriate)

- ☐ **No Poverty** – End poverty in all its forms everywhere.
- ☐ **Zero Hunger** – End hunger, achieve food security and improved nutrition, and promote sustainable agriculture.
- ✓ **Good Health and Well-being** – Ensure healthy lives and promote well-being for all at all ages.
- ☐ **Quality Education** – Ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all.
- ☐ **Gender Equality** – Achieve gender equality and empower all women and girls.
- ☐ **Clean Water and Sanitation** – Ensure availability and sustainable management of water and sanitation for all.
- ☐ **Affordable and Clean Energy** – Ensure access to affordable, reliable, sustainable, and modern energy for all.
- ✓ **Decent Work and Economic Growth** – Promote sustained, inclusive, and sustainable economic growth, full and productive employment, and decent work for all.
- ☐ **Industry, Innovation, and Infrastructure** – Build resilient infrastructure, promote inclusive and sustainable industrialization, and foster innovation.
- ☐ **Reduced Inequalities** – Reduce inequality within and among countries.
  Sustainable Cities and Communities – Make cities and human settlements inclusive, safe, resilient, and sustainable.
- ☐ **Responsible Consumption and Production** – Ensure sustainable consumption and production patterns.
- ☐ **Climate Action** – Take urgent action to combat climate change and its impacts.
- ☐ **Life Below Water** – Conserve and sustainably use the oceans, seas, and marine resources for sustainable development.
- ☐ **Life on Land** – Protect, restore, and promote sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, manage forests sustainably, combat desertification, and halt biodiversity loss.
- ☐ **Peace, Justice, and Strong Institutions** – Promote peaceful and inclusive societies, provide access to justice for all, and build effective, accountable institutions.
- ✓ **Partnerships for the Goals** – Strengthen the means of implementation and revitalize the Global Partnership for Sustainable Development.

6. Stakeholders:

Stakeholders	Purpose
Users / Customers	Use the platform to find, book, and pay for trusted home services quickly.
Service Providers (Plumbers, Electricians, etc.)	Register on the platform to receive jobs, earn income, and build ratings.
ConnectE Team	Develop, manage, and maintain the platform and ensure smooth operations.
Customer Support Team	Handle user queries, complaints, and dispute resolution.
Payment Providers	Enable secure and seamless digital transactions.
Local Partners / Communities	Help in provider onboarding and user acquisition through local networks.
Regulatory Authorities	Ensure compliance with local laws and safety standards.

7. Work Breakdown Structure:

Phase	Activities / Tasks
Phase 1	Problem identification and idea validation
Phase 2	Market research and competitor analysis
Phase 3	Product design (UX/UI, system architecture, core features)
Phase 4	Business model and financial planning
Phase 5	Marketing strategy and target customer segmentation
Phase 6	MVP development / prototype creation
Phase 7	Testing, feedback collection, and performance evaluation
Phase 8	Documentation, presentation, and final submission

8. Auditing Process/Monitoring/Performance Tracking:

- Platform tracks **user growth and service provider onboarding** to measure adoption.
- Key metrics such as **number of bookings, revenue generated, and service completion rate** are monitored regularly.
- **Dispute resolution data** is analyzed to ensure service quality and trust.
- Digital payment records and transaction logs ensure **transparency and secure transactions**.
- System monitors **app performance, uptime, and response time** to detect technical issues.
- Regular analysis of **CAC, LTV, and retention rates**; optimizes performance.

9. Marketing Strategies:

- Positioned as a **trust-first, real-time hyperlocal service platform**.
- Launch with a **hyperlocal focus (single city, limited services)**.
- User acquisition through **referrals, discounts, and first-time offers**.
- Provider acquisition via **local outreach and partnerships with technicians**.
- Collaborations with **apartment complexes and local communities**.
- Digital marketing through **social media and targeted ads**.
- Focus on highlighting key benefits: **fast booking, verified providers, real-time tracking, and transparency**.

10. SWOT Analysis of the Project:

S (Strength): • Hyperlocal, real-time service matching. • Strong focus on trust (verification, ratings) • Faster booking vs competitors • Clear value proposition (emergency + convenience) • Scalable marketplace model	W (Weakness): • Initial lack of brand trust • Difficulty in onboarding quality providers • Limited resources in early stage • Dependency on provider availability • Operational complexity (support, disputes)
O (Opportunity): • Untapped Tier-2 & Tier-3 markets • Rising demand for on-demand services • Increasing smartphone & digital payment adoption • Partnerships with apartments & local businesses • Expansion into multiple service categories	T (Threats): • Competition from established players • Price wars / low-cost competitors • Provider churn (switching platforms) • Maintaining service quality at scale • Regulatory or compliance issues

11. Market Analysis (Target Audience, Competitors, Quality Metrics):

The market analysis identifies the target customers, competitive landscape, and key performance indicators for the successful implementation of ConnectE.

<u>Target Audience</u>:

- Working professionals in Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities who require quick and reliable home services.
- Elderly households that prioritize safety, trust, and convenience in booking services.
- Apartment complexes and gated communities with recurring maintenance needs.
- Local service providers (plumbers, electricians, cleaners) seeking consistent job opportunities and digital visibility.

Market Opportunity:

- Increasing urbanization and nuclear families leading to higher demand for on-demand home services.
- Lack of reliable, real-time service booking platforms in Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities.
- Existing solutions are mostly directories, creating inefficiencies and trust issues.
- Rising smartphone usage and digital payments enabling seamless platform adoption.
- Growing preference for convenience, speed, and verified services among users.

Competitors:

- Established platforms like Urban Company that focus mainly on metro cities.
- Housejoy with limited reach and lower real-time capabilities.
- Local offline service providers relying on word-of-mouth and manual booking.
- Classified platforms that list services but lack verification and real-time matching.

Quality Metrics:

- High success rate of **service bookings and completions**.
- Fast **response and matching time** for service providers.
- Platform uptime of at least **99%** for reliability.
- Reduction in **average time to find and book a service**.
- High **customer satisfaction ratings and reviews**.
- Increased **provider utilization and repeat bookings**.

12. Impact of the project:

The ConnectE platform improves access to reliable home services by enabling real-time matching between users and verified service providers. Users benefit from faster booking, transparent pricing, and increased trust, reducing the stress and uncertainty associated with finding help during urgent situations.

Service providers gain consistent job opportunities, digital visibility, and secure payment systems, leading to improved income stability and reduced dependency on offline networks. The platform also enhances operational efficiency by streamlining booking, tracking, and communication processes.

From a broader perspective, ConnectE contributes to economic growth by supporting local service providers and promoting digital adoption. It also improves quality of life by saving time and effort for users, especially in urban environments. Overall, the platform creates a more efficient, transparent, and trustworthy service ecosystem.

13. Feedback Collection and Analysis:

Feedback from both users and service providers will be systematically collected to evaluate the effectiveness and user experience of the ConnectE platform. For users, feedback will be gathered through in-app ratings, reviews, and post-service surveys to assess satisfaction levels, service quality, and ease of use.

For service providers, feedback will be collected through dashboards, performance reports, and direct communication to understand challenges related to job allocation, earnings, and platform usability.

The collected data will be analyzed to identify trends in customer satisfaction, service quality, and operational efficiency. Insights will be used to improve platform features, enhance the user interface, refine matching algorithms, and strengthen customer support.

Regular feedback analysis ensures continuous improvement, helping ConnectE remain user-centric, reliable, and aligned with the needs of both customers and service providers.

14. DeAsra Certificate:

15. Referred Case Study details:

a. Name of Entrepreneur:
   Deepinder Goyal

b. Domain of Entrepreneur:
   Food Delivery, Restaurant Aggregation, Quick Commerce, Digital Platforms

c. Business Idea:
   To build a platform that helps users discover restaurants, read reviews, and order food online, while providing restaurants with increased visibility and customer reach through a digital marketplace.

d. Challenges:
   i. Intense competition from Swiggy
   ii. Maintaining profitability in a discount-driven market
   iii. Logistics and delivery management at scale
   iv. Customer retention and high acquisition costs
   v. Impact of COVID-19 on restaurant industry

e. Strategies:
   i. Strong focus on user experience and app interface
   ii. Expansion from restaurant discovery to full-scale food delivery
   iii. Aggressive marketing and discount strategies
   iv. Investment in delivery infrastructure and cloud kitchens
   v. Diversification into quick commerce (Zomato Blinkit)

f. Key Learnings:
   i. Start with a simple idea and scale gradually
   ii. Adapt business model based on market needs
   iii. Focus on customer experience and convenience
   iv. Be resilient in highly competitive markets
   v. Continuous innovation and diversification are key to growth

16. Conclusion of your project:

ConnectE successfully addresses the growing need for a reliable, fast, and trust-enabled platform for home services, especially in Tier-2 and emerging urban markets. By combining real-time matching, verified service providers, and transparent pricing, the platform overcomes the limitations of traditional service directories and unorganized local networks.

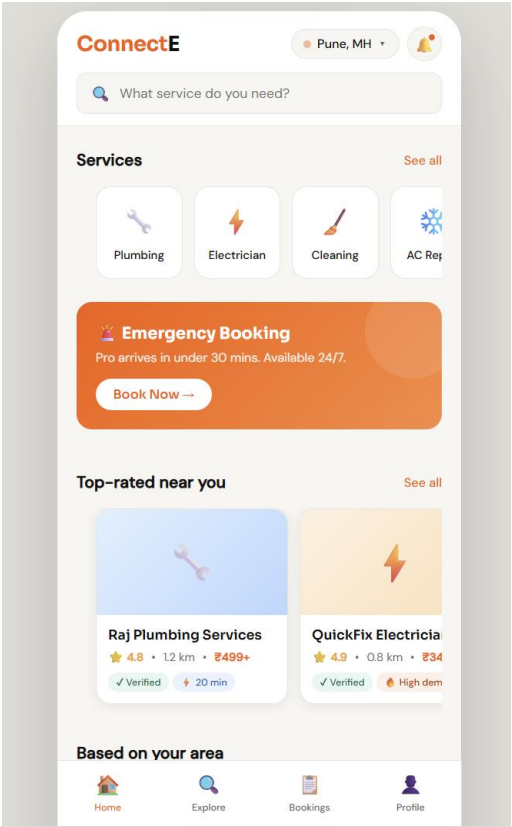
The project demonstrates strong potential for scalability through its marketplace model, supported by increasing digital adoption and demand for convenience-driven solutions. With a focused MVP approach, ConnectE prioritizes core functionalities such as booking, tracking, and secure payments while laying the foundation for future enhancements.

Overall, the project highlights a viable business opportunity with clear market demand, sustainable revenue streams, and measurable impact. With proper execution, ConnectE can evolve into a trusted ecosystem that benefits both users and service providers, contributing to a more organized and efficient service economy

17. References:

a) **Government of India.** Digital India Programme and Digital Payments Initiatives. Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, Government of India, 2023.
b) **NITI Aayog.** India's Urbanization and Service Economy Report. Government of India, 2022.
c) **World Bank.** Digital Platforms and the Gig Economy. World Bank Report, 2021.
d) **Urban Company.** Official Website and Business Model Insights.
e) **Housejoy.** Platform Overview and Service Model.
f) **Statista.** Online Home Services Market in India – Industry Statistics and Growth Trends, 2023.
g) **Entrepreneurship Development and Small Business Enterprises** by Poornima M. Charantimath, Pearson Education.
h) **Entrepreneurship: Successfully Launching New Ventures** by Bruce R. Barringer and R. Duane Ireland, Pearson.
i) **National Payments Corporation of India.** UPI and Digital Payment Guidelines, 2024.
j) **McKinsey & Company.** The Rise of Digital Marketplaces and On-Demand Services, 2022.

18. Appendix (Project Snaps):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Emergency Booking
Pro arrives in under 30 mins. Available 24/7.
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Top-rated near you
See all
Raj Plumbing Services
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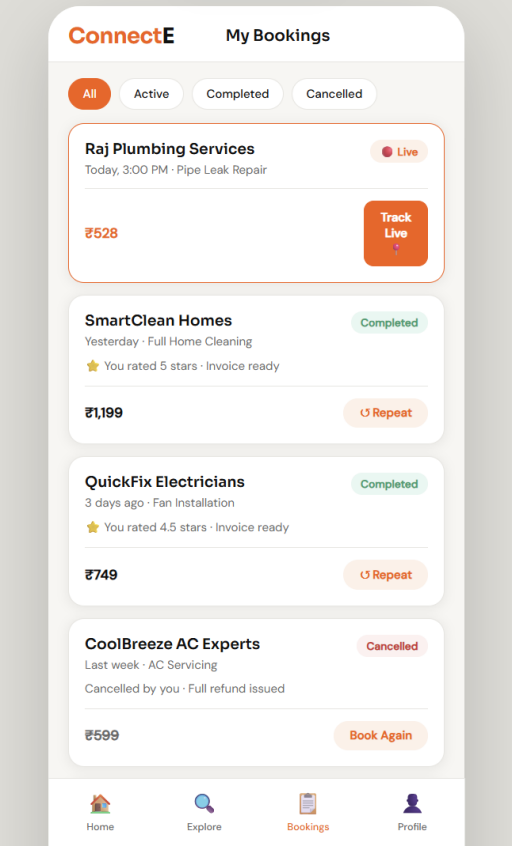
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Live
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Repeat
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You rated 4.5 stars · Invoice ready
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Cancelled
Last week · AC Servicing
Cancelled by you · Full refund issued
₹599
Book Again
Home
Explore
Bookings
Profile

Activity Log

Roll no.: 21168 Name: Prathamesh Harpale Role: Technical

Sr. No.	Task Carried out	Student Signature with Date	Teacher signature with Date
1.			
2.			
3.			
4.			
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Roll no.: 21181 Name: Srishti Pandey Role: Leader & Product

Sr. No.	Task Carried out	Student Signature with Date	Teacher signature with Date
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Roll no.: 21185 Name: Pradyum Umale Role: Marketing & Finance

Sr. No.	Task Carried out	Student Signature with Date	Teacher signature with Date
1.			
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Roll no.: 21187 Name: Abhay Wangwad Role: Ops & Research

Sr. No.	Task Carried out	Student Signature with Date	Teacher signature with Date
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